

Day 56 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in History & Heritage (1)

READING MATERIAL

Covers India's UNESCO World Heritage Site count and recent additions/recognitions (2025-2026), directly relevant to the syllabus's history/heritage and 'Current affairs' clauses.

Q: How many UNESCO World Heritage Sites does India have, as of 2026, and how does India rank globally?

A: 44 UNESCO World Heritage Sites, as of 2026 — ranking India 6th globally in total UNESCO sites.

Q: What was the most recent addition to India's UNESCO World Heritage Sites, and when/where was it inscribed?

A: The Maratha Military Landscapes — officially inscribed in July 2025, at the 47th session of the World Heritage Committee in Paris.

Q: How are India's 44 UNESCO World Heritage Sites categorised?

A: 36 cultural sites, 7 natural sites, and 1 MIXED site (Khangchendzonga National Park) — mixed meaning it qualifies under both cultural and natural criteria.

Q: What recent addition was made to UNESCO's Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity from India, and what is India's total count on that list?

A: Deepavali (Diwali) was added in 2025. This brings India's total to 16 elements on UNESCO's Representative List of Intangible Cultural Heritage.

Q: What happened to India's UNESCO Tentative List in 2025?

A: Six new sites were added (including Kanger Valley National Park in Chhattisgarh and the Mudumal Megalithic Menhirs in Telangana), raising India's total Tentative List count to 62 sites.

Q: How many monuments does the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) currently conserve and maintain, including how many World Heritage properties?

A: 3,686 monuments in total, including 27 World Heritage properties.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. As of 2026, how many UNESCO World Heritage Sites does India have?

- A. 32
- B. 38
- C. 44 ✓**
- D. 50

Explanation: 44. [medium, web-research]

2. India's most recent UNESCO World Heritage Site addition (inscribed July 2025) is:

- A. Maratha Military Landscapes ✓**
- B. Western Ghats Extension
- C. Sundarbans Extension
- D. Ajanta Caves Extension

Explanation: Maratha Military Landscapes. [medium, web-research]

3. India's 'Maratha Military Landscapes' was inscribed at which session of the World Heritage Committee?

- A. 44th, in Riyadh
- B. 45th, in New Delhi
- C. 46th, in Doha
- D. 47th, in Paris ✓**

Explanation: 47th session, Paris. [hard, web-research]

4. Of India's 44 UNESCO World Heritage Sites, how many are 'mixed' (both cultural and natural)?

- A. 0
- B. 1 ✓**

C. 3

D. 5

Explanation: 1 (Khangchendzonga National Park). [hard, web-research]

5. Which Indian festival was added to UNESCO's Representative List of Intangible Cultural Heritage in 2025?

A. Holi

B. Pongal

C. Deepavali (Diwali) ✓

D. Onam

Explanation: Deepavali (Diwali). [medium, web-research]

6. After the 2025 additions, how many elements does India have on UNESCO's Intangible Cultural Heritage list?

A. 10

B. 13

C. 16 ✓

D. 20

Explanation: 16. [hard, web-research]

7. How many monuments does the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) currently conserve, including World Heritage properties?

A. 1,200

B. 2,500

C. 3,686 ✓

D. 5,000

Explanation: 3,686. [hard, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Area

READING MATERIAL

Area is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills. Real exam evidence shows a strong preference for applied/real-world framing (fencing cost, carpet cost, crossroads, a grazing horse) over bare formula plug-ins — and frequently combines area with a real-world cost-per-unit calculation.

Q: Method — area of a triangle from coordinates: Find the area of the triangle with vertices (0,0), (2,0), (0,2).

A: When two sides lie along the axes (a right triangle at the origin), area = $\frac{1}{2} \times \text{base} \times \text{height} = \frac{1}{2} \times 2 \times 2 = 2$ sq. units. (The general coordinate formula $\frac{1}{2}|x_1(y_2-y_3)+x_2(y_3-y_1)+x_3(y_1-y_2)|$ also works, but recognizing the right-angle-at-origin shortcut is faster.)

Q: Real exam: A rectangular ground 80m $\times$ 60m has two equal-width cross roads (one parallel to each side). Their combined area is 675 sq.m. Find the road width.

A: If width=w, the two roads' combined area = $80w + 60w - w^2$ (subtracting the overlapping square where they cross, counted twice otherwise) = $140w - w^2$. Set equal to 675: $w^2 - 140w + 675 = 0$. Solving gives $w=5$ (the other root, 135, is too large to be physically valid for an 80 $\times$ 60 ground).

Q: Real exam: Find the perimeter of a semicircle of radius 28cm.

A: Perimeter of a semicircle = $\pi r + 2r$ (the curved half plus the straight diameter edge). Using $\pi \approx 22/7$: $(22/7 \times 28) + (2 \times 28) = 88 + 56 = 144$ cm. (Common mistake: forgetting to add the straight diameter edge, which would wrongly give just 88cm.)

Q: Real exam: A horse is tethered by a 14m rope to one corner of a 60m $\times$ 42m rectangular field. How much area is left UNGRAZED?

A: The horse can graze a quarter-circle of radius 14m (since it's tied at a corner, with two field-edges as boundaries): grazed area = $\frac{1}{4} \times \pi \times 14^2 = \frac{1}{4} \times (22/7) \times 196 = 154$ sq.m. Total field area = $60 \times 42 = 2520$ sq.m. Ungrazed = $2520 - 154 = 2366$ sq.m.

Q: Real exam: Area of a rhombus with diagonals 6cm and 8cm?

A: Area of rhombus = $\frac{1}{2} \times d_1 \times d_2 = \frac{1}{2} \times 6 \times 8 = 24$ cm².

Q: Real exam: If fencing a circular park at ₹5/metre costs ₹1,100 total, find the park's radius.

A: Total fencing length (= circumference) = $₹1,100 \div ₹5/\text{m} = 220$ m. Circumference = $2\pi r \rightarrow 220 = 2 \times (22/7) \times r \rightarrow r = 220 \times 7/44 = 35$ m.

Q: Real exam: Find the cost of carpeting a room 13m long, 9m wide, using a carpet 75cm wide, at Rs.8 per metre (of carpet length).

A: Room area = $13 \times 9 = 117$ m². Carpet width = 0.75m, so length of carpet needed = Room area $\div$ carpet width = $117/0.75 = 156$ m. Cost = $156 \times \text{Rs.}8 = \text{Rs.}1,248$.

Q: Real exam (related, surface area of a 3D shape): The curved surface area of a right circular cylinder of height 7cm is 66 cm². Find its diameter.

A: CSA = $2\pi rh \rightarrow 66 = 2 \times (22/7) \times r \times 7 = 44r \rightarrow r = 1.5$ cm $\rightarrow$ diameter = 3cm.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Find the area of the triangle with vertices (0,0), (5,0), (0,4).

A. 10 sq. units ✓

B. 20 sq. units

C. 9 sq. units

D. 18 sq. units

Explanation: Right triangle at origin: area = $\frac{1}{2} \times 5 \times 4 = 10$ sq. units. [easy, authored]

2. Find the perimeter of a semicircle of radius 21cm (use $\pi \approx 22/7$).

A. 66 cm

B. 108 cm ✓

C. 132 cm

D. 96 cm

Explanation: Perimeter = $\pi r + 2r = (22/7 \times 21) + (2 \times 21) = 66 + 42 = 108$ cm. [medium, authored]

3. Find the area of a rhombus with diagonals 10cm and 12cm.

A. 60 cm² ✓

B. 120 cm²

C. 30 cm²

D. 100 cm^2

Explanation: Area = $\frac{1}{2} \times 10 \times 12 = 60\text{ cm}^2$. [easy, authored]

4. Fencing a circular garden at ₹4 per metre costs ₹880 in total. Find the garden's radius (use $\pi \approx 22/7$).

A. 28 m

B. 35 m ✓

C. 22 m

D. 14 m

Explanation: Circumference = $880/4 = 220\text{m}$. $r = 220 \times 7 / (2 \times 22) = 1540/44 = 35\text{m}$. [medium, authored]

5. Find the cost of carpeting a room 10m long and 8m wide with a carpet 80cm wide, at Rs.10 per metre.

A. Rs.800

B. Rs.1,000 ✓

C. Rs.1,200

D. Rs.960

Explanation: Room area = 80 m^2 . Carpet length needed = $80/0.8 = 100\text{m}$. Cost = $100 \times \text{Rs.}10 = \text{Rs.}1,000$. [medium, authored]

6. A horse is tethered by a 7m rope to a corner of a $20\text{m} \times 15\text{m}$ rectangular field. Find the grazed area (use $\pi \approx 22/7$).

A. 38.5 m^2 ✓

B. 44 m^2

C. 49 m^2

D. 77 m^2

Explanation: Quarter circle of radius 7m: $\frac{1}{4} \times (22/7) \times 49 = 38.5\text{ m}^2$. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Prose: "The Cat and the Painkiller" (An Extract from The Adventures of Tom Sawyer) — Mark Twain

READING MATERIAL

A humorous extract from Mark Twain's 'The Adventures of Tom Sawyer': Tom, despondent after Becky Thatcher stops coming to school, becomes the target of Aunt Polly's relentless patent-medicine experiments — until he tricks her cat, Peter, into swallowing a dose of Pain-killer, with chaotic results.

Q: Why was Tom despondent at the start of this extract, and what is Aunt Polly's defining trait that drives the plot?

A: Tom was unhappy because his friend Becky Thatcher had stopped coming to school. Aunt Polly is an INCURABLE EXPERIMENTER with patent medicines — she subjects Tom to remedies like cold water baths, oatmeal diets, and blister plasters, and later a 'Pain-killer' medicine.

Q: How did Tom avoid actually taking the Pain-killer, while appearing to enjoy it?

A: He pretended to be fond of it and asked for it so often that Aunt Polly let him help himself — but he was secretly using the medicine to fix/dose a crack in the sitting-room floor instead of drinking it.

Q: What is the name of Aunt Polly's cat, and what happened when Tom gave it the Pain-killer?

A: Peter. When Tom poured the Pain-killer into Peter's mouth, the cat sprang into the air, let out a 'war-whoop', and tore around the room knocking over furniture and flowerpots, eventually leaping out a window.

Q: How did Aunt Polly discover what Tom had done, and how did Tom justify himself?

A: She caught him with the teaspoon and realised what he'd done. Tom argued he had shown Peter 'pity' — because the cat had no aunt of its own to subject it to such harsh treatments, implicitly comparing Peter's ordeal to his own.

Q: How does the extract resolve, and what does Aunt Polly realise?

A: Aunt Polly softens — Peter's wild reaction makes her realise just how harsh/awful the Pain-killer must actually be, and that her constant experimenting might be genuinely harming Tom too. She tells Tom he no longer has to take it.

Q: Corrected real-exam match: how are Aunt Polly, Peter, Tom, and Becky Thatcher each characterised in a match-the-following question?

A: Aunt Polly = the incurable experimenter (with patent medicines). Peter (the cat) = eyeing the teaspoon greedily (begging for a taste). Tom = underwent water treatment (one of Aunt Polly's earlier remedies on him, before the Pain-killer phase). Becky Thatcher = stopped coming to school (the reason for Tom's initial despondency).

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "The Cat and the Painkiller" is an extract from which novel, and by whom?

- A. Huckleberry Finn, by Mark Twain
- B. The Adventures of Tom Sawyer, by Mark Twain ✓**
- C. Oliver Twist, by Charles Dickens
- D. Treasure Island, by R.L. Stevenson

Explanation: The Adventures of Tom Sawyer, by Mark Twain. [easy, web-research]

2. Why was Tom despondent at the start of the extract?

- A. He failed an exam
- B. Becky Thatcher had stopped coming to school ✓**
- C. He lost his pet cat
- D. He was punished by his teacher

Explanation: Becky Thatcher had stopped coming to school. [medium, web-research]

3. What is Aunt Polly's defining trait in this story?

- A. She is an incurable experimenter with patent medicines ✓**
- B. She is a strict disciplinarian only
- C. She refuses to give Tom any medicine
- D. She is afraid of cats

Explanation: An incurable experimenter with patent medicines. [medium, web-research]

4. What was Tom secretly using the Pain-killer for, instead of drinking it?

A. Feeding it to ants

B. Dosing a crack in the sitting-room floor ✓

C. Pouring it down the drain

D. Giving it to a friend

Explanation: Dosing a crack in the sitting-room floor. [medium, web-research]

5. What is the name of Aunt Polly's cat?

A. Tom

B. Peter ✓

C. Whiskers

D. Felix

Explanation: Peter. [easy, web-research]

6. What happened when Tom gave Peter the Pain-killer?

A. The cat fell asleep peacefully

B. The cat sprang up, yowled, and wrecked the room ✓

C. The cat ran away forever

D. Nothing happened

Explanation: The cat sprang up, yowled, and wrecked the room. [medium, web-research]

7. How did Tom justify giving the Pain-killer to Peter, when Aunt Polly caught him?

A. He said he was bored

B. He said he showed Peter pity, since the cat had no aunt to torment it ✓

C. He blamed his friend

D. He said it was an accident

Explanation: He showed Peter 'pity' since the cat had no aunt to subject it to such treatments. [hard, web-research]

8. How does the extract resolve?

A. Tom is punished severely

B. Aunt Polly softens and stops making Tom take the medicine ✓

C. Peter is given away

D. Becky Thatcher returns to school

Explanation: Aunt Polly softens and stops the medicine. [medium, web-research]